

Building a Paper Auto-Trade System That Follows Big-Money Flow on IDX

Component anatomy with the Indonesia-specific traps that actually sink these systems

1. Data ingestion — the binding constraint

Broker summary (net buy/sell per broker per stock per day) is the heart of bandarmology and the hardest piece to source cleanly on IDX. The critical question isn't *getting* it but **timing**: when does EOD broker summary actually publish relative to next session's open? If your signal uses data that wasn't available when you'd have traded, every backtest is look-ahead-biased fantasy. You also need OHLCV, foreign net flow (foreign vs domestic broker classification or KSEI ownership), corporate actions, and suspension/halt flags so you don't trade phantom liquidity.

2. Signal definition — what is “big money”

You have to operationalize “bandar” precisely: top-N broker net-buy concentration, foreign net flow, accumulation over a rolling window, and price/flow divergence (price flat while a few brokers quietly accumulate is the classic setup). The reflexivity problem is real — broker flow is partly manipulable, so a naive “follow the top buyer” rule gets you front-run or trapped in distribution dressed as accumulation.

3. Universe screening

Liquidity filter is non-negotiable: in thin names the flow signal *is* the manipulation, not a read on it. Tier by market cap / value traded, exclude fresh IPOs, suspended names, and stocks pinned at ARA/ARB where you couldn't actually fill.

4. Paper fill engine with IDX microstructure

This is where most paper systems lie to you. Model lot size (100 shares), tick bands (fraksi harga), ARA/ARB auto-rejection (you can't buy at ARA or sell at ARB — orders queue or reject), and realistic fill assumptions (next-open with slippage, not magic close fills). Model the full fee stack: broker buy/sell fees, levy, VAT, and the 0.1% sales tax on sells. Skipping fees alone can flip a “winning” flow strategy negative.

5. Backtest + forward paper, separated

Historical backtest for validation (with survivorship and look-ahead controls), then live forward paper trading as the real out-of-sample test. Treat them as different code paths sharing the same fill engine.

6. Benchmark & evaluation

Pick the benchmark deliberately — IHSG is too broad if your universe is large-caps; LQ45 or a sector index is often the honest comparison. Track return, Sharpe, max drawdown, hit rate, and turnover (flow strategies churn, and fees punish churn).

7. Orchestration

Scheduler keyed to broker-summary availability, not market close — ingest, compute signals, generate paper orders, then reconcile fills next session.

The fork that decides tradeability: of the broker-summary timing/availability problem, the signal definition, and fill realism, whichever you're currently stuck on is usually what determines whether the whole system is actually tradeable rather than a backtest artifact.